

PySpark & Databricks Short Notes

1. cast() vs try_cast()

cast = strict, try_cast = safe (returns NULL)

2. coalesce()

Returns first non-null value

3. expr()

Used to write Spark SQL expressions

4. select vs selectExpr

select = PySpark style

selectExpr = SQL style

5. Alias Dependency

Do not reuse aliases in same select/selectExpr

6. withColumnRenamed

Only renames column, does not drop others

7. StructType

Defines schema with full control

8. Data Types

StringType, IntegerType, DoubleType, DateType, ArrayType, MapType, StructType

9. case when

SQL conditional logic, always ends with END

10. uuid4 + lit

Used to generate batch_id

Golden Rule:

Prefer safe, step-by-step transformations in production.